How to Cite Our Data Source

If you are using more than one database from the warehouse in your work, the proper way to cite is as follows:

- GC Wealth Project Data, [year], accessed via http://wealthproject.gc.cuny.edu, on [date]. If you are only using one specific database from our data warehouse, the proper way to cite the database is as follows:
- GC Wealth Project Data - Wealth Inequality Trends Database, [year], accessed via http://wealthproject.gc.cuny.edu, on [date].
- GC Wealth Project Data - Wealth Topography Database, [year], accessed via http://wealthproject.gc.cuny.edu, on [date].
- GC Wealth Project Data - Estate, Inheritance, and Gifts Taxation Database, [year], accessed via http://wealthproject.gc.cuny.edu, on [date].

Please include the citation in your bibliography: If you use GC Wealth Project data in a report, monograph, paper, book, book chapter, journal article, dissertation, etc., include the citation in your bibliography, alphabetized under "G."

Table 1: Warehouse Columns

GEO	GEO_long	year	percentile	varcode	value	value_str	source	longname	last_update

General Warehouse Structure

This section provides a comprehensive overview of the general structure of the data warehouse of the GC Wealth Project.

The data warehouse is organized in long format with a total of nine columns.

First of all, important information codifying the nature of the variable listed in the warehouse is stored in the column named *varcode*, and this is detailed in its own subsection below. Two additional columns store values related to each *varcode*. On the one hand, the column *value* stores numerical values like amounts in nominal currency, indices, shares, or rates. On the other hand, the column *value_str* stores textual information, such as details on how taxes are applied in a given country.

There are five additional columns providing geographical and temporal information, population of reference, and sources (*GEO, GEO_long, year, percentile, source*). The *GEO* column refers to 2-character ISO codes for countries, while the *GEO_long* column refers to their full name. The *year* column is an integer variable, while the *percentile* column defines the population to which each observation corresponds. This is a string variable that takes values such as "p0p100" when observations refer to the whole population, as mostly happens with the Wealth Topography dashboard. Other percentiles, as appear in the Wealth Inequality Trends section, can be defined using values between 0 and 100. For instance, the top 0.1% share of the population would be referred to as "p99.9p100". The source column contains information about the identifier of the specific source of the data.

Finally, the variable *longname* is a string variable providing a description in plain language of each observation. . This is defined automatically by an algorithm that draws all labels from our codebook/dictionary file (named dictionary.xlsx), available in our GitHub repository.

Importantly, the data warehouse is also available in a more detailed version, which contains a long list of descriptive metadata information. The complete warehouse is *warehouse_meta*. Metadata include information such as comments on the methodology used to compile the data, and any limitations or caveats associated with the data, as well as detailed information about the definition of our variables, units of analysis, and full spelling of the sources of data, including links to full curated bibliographic citation details. The metadata version is essential for researchers and analysts who require a deeper understanding of the underlying data and its quality. It is available for download alongside the warehouse and can also be accessed through our website and repository.

The varcode

The *varcode* column allows users to identify the variable and concept at hand. It is also designed to indicate information about the specific warehouse section and sector, as well as section-specific information. Each *varcode* variable has a pre-determined structure, and consists of five main components: Section, Sector, Variable Type, Concept, and Section-Specific info.

$$\underbrace{A}_{Section} - \underbrace{BB}_{Sector} - \underbrace{CCC}_{VariableType} - \underbrace{DDDDD}_{Concept} - \underbrace{ZZ}_{Section-Specific}$$

The first 1-digit component, Section, defines the broad section in which the variable belongs, such as the Wealth Inequality Trends or the Wealth Topography section.

Table 2: Section codes

code	label
x	Estate, Inheritance, and Gift Taxes
t	Wealth Inequality Trends
p	Wealth Topography

The 2-digit Sector component provides additional granularity, such as the specific institutional sector being measured, e.g., the Household sector including the Non-Profit Institutions Serving Households.

The 3-digit Variable Type component denotes the type of variable being measured, e.g., the Gini coefficient, Top or Bottom shares, a tax threshold or aggregate wealth.

The 6-digit Concept component provides more detailed information about the variable being measured, such as the specific metric being used, while the 2-digit Section-Specific component can be used to further characterize the variable within a particular section of the warehouse (e.g., in the context of the Estate, Inheritance, and Gift Taxes section, each variable will be associated to a particular tax bracket if necessary).

Supplementary Variables

To enhance users' capacity for insightful comparisons and analysis, our website offers various transformations of the data through data visualizations. These transformations encompass inflation adjustments, currency conversion rates, population estimates (such as per capita or per adult), and macroeconomic values. The data used for these transformations is sourced from the World Inequality Database, downloaded on November 4th, 2022.

We have made the code used to extract these variables available on our GitHub repository, stored in a downloadable file called "supplementary_var.xlsx". Users can easily access and review the code, enabling them to understand the data processing steps and reproduce the results displayed on our website if desired. This file contains all the relevant data in a structured format, allowing users to explore the variables at their own pace and integrate them into their own analyses.

Table **??** in Appendix **??** below provides a summary of the supplementary variables employed in the project. For more comprehensive information on the construction of these variables, please consult their original documentation ([@Blanchet2017], [@BlanchetChancel2016]).